middleware can handle an appropriate request by invoking a method known as a handler and using the result to generate a response. Previous chapters described using minimal API endpoint handlers, but there are other types of handlers, such as MVC action methods and Razor Pages, as you'll learn in part 2 of this book.

One aspect that I've glossed over so far is *how* the `EndpointMiddleware` selects which handler executes when you receive a request. What makes a request appropriate for a given handler? The process of mapping a request to a handler is *routing*.

DEFINITION *Routing* in ASP.NET Core is the process of selecting a specific handler for an incoming HTTP request. In minimal APIs, the handler is the endpoint handler associated with a route. In Razor Pages, the handler is a page handler method defined in a Razor Page. In MVC, the handler is an action method in a controller.

In chapters 3 to 5, you saw several simple applications built with minimal APIs. In chapter 5, you learned the basics of routing for minimal APIs, but it's worth exploring *why* routing is useful as well as how to use it. Even a simple URL path such as `/person` uses routing to determine which handler should be executed, as shown in figure 6.1.